

1989

Ivory ban

The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species (CITES) instituted a worldwide ban on the trade in ivory. The ban came about in response to a rise in poachers killing elephants for their tusks, which halved the African elephant population between 1979 and 1989.



Burning elephant tusks seized by authorities in Nairobi, Kenya, 1995

1989

Arranging atoms

A team of scientists at IBM used a scanning tunneling microscope (STM) to arrange 35 atoms of the element xenon on a chilled crystal of the element nickel to spell out IBM. Considered a landmark in the field of nanotechnology, this was the first time that individual atoms had been ordered and positioned on a flat surface.



1988

The Morris Worm

The Morris Worm became the first computer virus to infect computers across the internet. Written by a university student, Robert Tappan Morris, the virus infected as many as 10 percent of all internet-connected computers at the time, causing them to slow down or halt until it was removed.

1989

Game Boy launched

Nintendo's handheld computer gaming machine, the Game Boy, was launched in Japan. Each Game Boy came with the falling blocks puzzle game, *Tetris*. Despite its small 3-in- (6.6-cm-) grayscale screen, more than 118 million units of the Game Boy—and a color-screen variant called the Game Boy Color—were sold.



1990

1986 3-D PRINTING

Charles W. Hull holding a 3-D printed mask of his face in 2000.

The first 3-D printer

American engineer Charles W. Hull received a patent for his 3-D printer, the SLA-1, in 1986. The printer used lasers to build objects from polymer resin according to instructions from a computer.

Three-dimensional (3-D) printing includes a range of processes in which thin layers of metal, plastic, or some other material are “printed” (laid down) on top of one another until a 3-D object is formed. The directions for the precise shape of each layer are stored in a computer’s memory. 3-D printing allows objects to be made quickly and on demand.

**Printing parts**

3-D printing is now used in industry to make prototypes and working parts for machines and vehicles. For instance, the Airbus A350 WXB airliner contains more than 1,000 3-D printed parts. Artificial body parts such as dental crowns, bone grafts, and prosthetic limbs can also be 3-D printed.

A model of a 3-D printed heart. Models of organs can be 3-D printed to help doctors plan and explain complicated surgeries.